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Prompt Patterns

Use this when: a plain prompt gives messy, wrong or inconsistent answers and you need a proven structure.

Works with Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini
Sheet v1.0 · Oct 2026

6 patterns that fix most prompts

Add them to the AI-01 parts

1 Few-shot

You need the same format or style every time.

Give 3 to 5 varied input and output examples

2 Step by step

Troubleshooting, math or anything with logic.

"Reason step by step, then give the final answer."

3 Structured output

The answer feeds a script, table or ticket.

Return only JSON with keys: cause, fix, risk

4 Critique and revise

You need fewer errors in a draft or answer.

"Check your answer for mistakes, then fix them."

5 Prompt chain

The job is big: split it into small prompts.

1) list the options 2) rank them
3) write it up

6 Ask first

Key facts are missing from your request.

"Ask up to 3 questions before you answer."

Pick by problem

Format keeps changing	1 or 3
Answer is rushed or wrong	2 then 4
Task is too big	5
Answer is too generic	6
Output goes into a tool	3, then validate

Structured output tips

Name the exact keys and allowed values

Say "JSON only, no extra text"

Allow `null` or "unknown" instead of guessing

Parse and validate before you use it

Show one finished example

Stack them: one prompt, four patterns

SOC log triage

Role: You are a SOC analyst. **Task:** Triage the lines in <logs>.
Few-shot: <example>denied tcp 198.51.100.7 to 192.0.2.10:22 => ACTION</example>
Step by step: Reason through each line first.
Structured: Then return JSON: [{"line": "...", "label": "ACTION|ROUTINE", "why": "..."}]
Critique: Re-read your labels once and fix any mistakes.

Combine them

- 1 + 3 Examples that all end in the same JSON shape
 - 2 + 4 Think it through, then review before the final answer
 - 6 + 5 Ask questions first, then run the chain
 - 3 + 4 Ask it to check its JSON against your keys
- Wrap examples in tags and keep them varied so the AI does not copy one.

Use patterns safely

OWASP LLM Top 10 (2025)

DANGER Never run AI-written commands on production unread. Test them in a lab.

CAUTION Validate JSON and commands before a script uses them. AI output is untrusted input.

CAUTION Mask real data in your examples. Tag pasted text as data, not instructions.



3 to 5 varied examples beat a long rule list

Step-by-step text can sound sure and be wrong

One pattern at a time: test, then combine